My story "Youth" 1 appeared in the May 1952 issue of Space Science Fiction. It was the first issue of that magazine—one of the many that suddenly weighed down the magazine stands. Few of them lasted long. Space lasted only eight issues.

It wasn't a bad magazine. It couldn't be bad, since Lester del Rey was editing it. Lester had difficulties with the publisher, however, and even he couldn't overcome that handicap.

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Copies of Biochemistry and Human Metabolism arrived on May 24, 1952. It was my first nonfiction book, and I was terribly proud. I remember that Matthew Derow picked it up, opened it at random, and said instantly, "You've got a wrong formula here."

"Go on," I said in disbelief, assuming he was kidding, for Walker, Boyd and I had spent endless hours checking over every formula for accuracy. He showed me and, for goodness' sake, he was right.

We used the book as a text for the next teaching semester (my fourth) and offered trivial bonuses to any student who found a typographical error. On the one hand, it helped insure careful reading; on the other, we would find errors that we could correct in future printings.

It worked entirely too well. After our careful triple proofreading, the students found so many errors that even at a dime a throw (and a quarter for a mistake in a formula) it seemed to represent a serious financial drain. Unbelievable!

In the Waltham apartment, meanwhile, there were two built-in bookcases on either side of the fireplace. They were very small bookcases, but I guess the architects and designers didn't read—just as I didn't use the fireplace.

We did use the bookcases, though. On the top shelf at the right side I placed a copy of each of my books in chronological order, and it

1 Ste The Martian Way and Other Stories (Doubleday, 1955).

gave me a certain austere pleasure to place Biochemistry and Human Metabolism in its correct place, immediately behind my juvenile. I showed the textbook no favoritism.

While the book was in preparation, Dick Hoover of Williams & Wilkins was